

The House Legacy Builds:

**A Formative Evaluation of the Impact of the
Legacy Resident Retention Program (LRRP)
on Participant Quality of Life**



Produced for
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Atlanta Beltline Partnership

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SUMMARY

This program evaluation of the LRRP examined the following question:

How has the LRRP influenced its participants' quality of life?

For the purposes of this **Formative evaluation of Program Effects (Outcome & Impact)**, a positive influence on quality of life was measured by improvements to participants' financial and emotional well-being. The evaluation results will inform future decisions regarding the program.

The goal was to understand the program's effects, such as the immediate impact of the program on its participants (i.e., the outcome), and the long-term effect of the program on the larger community (i.e., the impact) as measured by success in meeting six LRRP Specific, Measurable, Ambitious, Achievable, Relevant, Time-limited, Inclusive, and Equitable (**SMAARTIE**) **Outcome objectives** for LRRP Program Objective #1: "The LRRP will enhance the quality of life for residents of Beltline neighborhoods." The evaluation-relevant Outcome objectives for LRRP Program Objective #1 are listed below.

By the end of March 2026:

- 1a:** 70% of current LRRP participants who have received property tax payments will have completed a program evaluation survey.
- 1b:** 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report less worry about losing their homes after joining LRRP.
- 1c:** 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report that having their property taxes paid has helped them plan better for their future (i.e. feeling financially secure, having access to more resources).
- 1d:** 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report experiencing less worry or stress about money than they did before joining the LRRP.
- 1e:** 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report no longer struggling to pay for at least 3 of 5 metrics including: groceries or food, healthcare or prescriptions, home repairs or maintenance, transportation, utilities or bills after joining the LRRP.

We used quotes from focus group data and survey responses to examine participants' quality of life to determine if these objectives have been met,. Additionally, we used inclusive evaluation practices to reduce bias and foster cooperation among members of the program evaluation team (See list of inclusive practices we used in Appendix 4.3).

After data collection and analysis, we used our findings to form **data-driven conclusions** beginning with concluding that **the LRRP objectives listed above have been met or partially met**. Based on evaluation findings we are also making the following recommendations for further improvement.

1. Incentivize and enhance outreach strategies to recruit more LRRP participants
2. Increase community engagement between the Atlanta Beltline Partnership and LRRP participants and neighborhoods
3. Extend the LRRP beyond 2030 to improve legacy resident quality of life, if feasible
4. Expand the scope of the LRRP to assist with home repairs and maintenance, if feasible

GLOSSARY

Term	Definition
Concept Map	A visual depiction of a program's key ideas, assumptions, and links
Data Collection Consultant	A person who possesses a deep level of information and/or valuable insight on the data collection methods needed to complete an evaluation
Data Collection Crosswalk	A table that links information sought by an evaluation (domains) with the data collection method used (indicators)
Evaluation Purpose	The reason why an evaluation is being done
Evaluation Shareholder	Any person who has an interest in the evaluation of a specific program
Formative Evaluation	A type of evaluation that helps re-form the future direction of a program by creating actionable recommendations
Key Shareholder	Any person who has the authority to use the findings from an evaluation to make changes to the program
Logic Model	A visual depiction of the central components of a program (shareholders, inputs, activities, outcomes, and impacts), that displays the relationships between components.
Open Coding	An exploratory type of qualitative data analysis
Primary Intended User (PIU)	The person(s) most likely to use their authority to make changes to a program based on evaluation findings
Sampling: Purposive	A sampling strategy that is used to recruit participants based on specific characteristics that are relevant to the evaluation objectives
SMAART[IE]	An acronym that stands for Specific, Measurable, Ambitions, Achievable, Relevant, Time-limited, and, in some cases, Inclusive, and/or Equitable. These criteria used to create rigorous outcome objectives
SORK Table	SORK is an acronym that stands for Significance, Opportunity, Resources, and Knowledge. SORK Tables are a practical method of prioritizing recommendations based on the findings and conclusions developed through data analysis
Thematic Analysis	A type of qualitative data analysis that categorizes data by themes, patterns, or concepts
Triangulation	The use of multiple different methods, assessors, theories, time periods, and/or data sources are used to check if the information triangulates or converges

PART I

A. EVALUATION PROJECT FINDINGS

How has the LRRP influenced its participants' quality of life?

This process began by conducting a Data Collection Consultant Interview (DCCI), followed by canvassing and talking to LRRP residents using a survey tool provided by the LRRP. Additionally, our findings use the results of two prior rounds of surveys and quotes from focus group transcripts, also provided to our team by our LRRP community partners.

To strengthen validity, we used data, investigators, and environmental triangulation. Findings show participants' responses fell into two quality of life categories: financial and emotional well-being. Under each category are themes that reflect motivations, needs, anxieties, the impact of the LRRP, and community outreach.

“The support from the LRRP gave me peace of mind. It allowed me to focus on other things...without the fear of losing my home.”

Demographics

Demographic data was collected to provide more context on who the LRRP was serving. See Appendix 3 for all raw data.

Employment Status: The majority of LRRP participants were **retired (42%)**, followed by working (41%), other (10%) or unemployed (7%)

Race and Ethnicity: The majority of LRRP participants identified as **Black/African (73%)**, followed by White participants (13%) and American Indian or Alaska Native (4%).

Disability Status: A majority of LRRP respondents were **not disabled (67%)**, 27% did have disability status, the remaining 6% either selected other or prefer not to say.

Veteran Status: The majority of LRRP respondents were **not veterans (81%)**, 11% were veterans, 6% reported that someone in their household is a veteran, and 1% chose not to say.

Financial Wellbeing

After joining the LRRP program, **65% of respondents were less worried** to some degree **about losing their home.**

There were three main responses participants gave when asked, ***“Why did you decide to join the LRRP?”***:

- 1. Rising property taxes**
- 2. Passing on their home to future generations**
- 3. Fear of losing their home**

Need for Maintenance and Home Repairs

Participants across employment groups reported reduced difficulty with paying for home repairs and maintenance after joining the LRRP. The program also improved affordability in other essential areas, with respondents reporting less difficulty paying for **utility bills (19%)** and **food and groceries (16%)**. However, participants still faced **difficult trade-offs**, including forgoing doctor's appointments, choosing between paying for medical prescriptions or home repairs, and sacrificing time with their families.

Overall, working, retired and “other” employment categories struggled less to pay for home repairs and maintenance after joining the LRRP program:

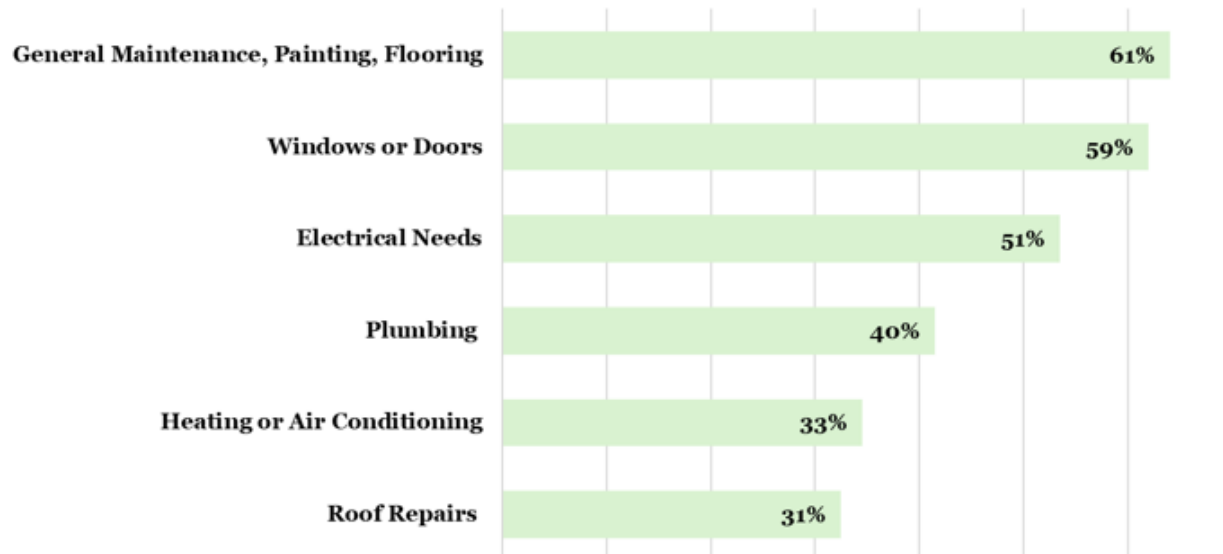


Figure 1: Struggle to pay for home repairs and maintenance before and after joining the LRRP

When asked about the most common types of repairs needed, respondents identified:



Figure 2: Does your home need any repairs or improvements right now? (Select all that apply)

Emotional Wellbeing

Our findings on participants' emotional quality of life were primarily through qualitative analysis. We found recurring themes of anxiety, fear of displacement and a general mistrust that the city of Atlanta is looking to buy their neighborhoods. There was also gratitude for the program, strong informal networks (such as churches and neighbors), and stories of growing up in Atlanta and wanting to give to future generations.

Impact of LRRP on Stress and Worry

Overall, participants reported that the LRRP had reduced their financial stress. **54%** said they felt **less worried or stressed** about money after joining the program; **40%** reported **no change** to worry or stress, and **6%** said they felt **more stressed since** joining the program.

“Knowing I will have assistance in paying property taxes until 2030 feels like a relief”

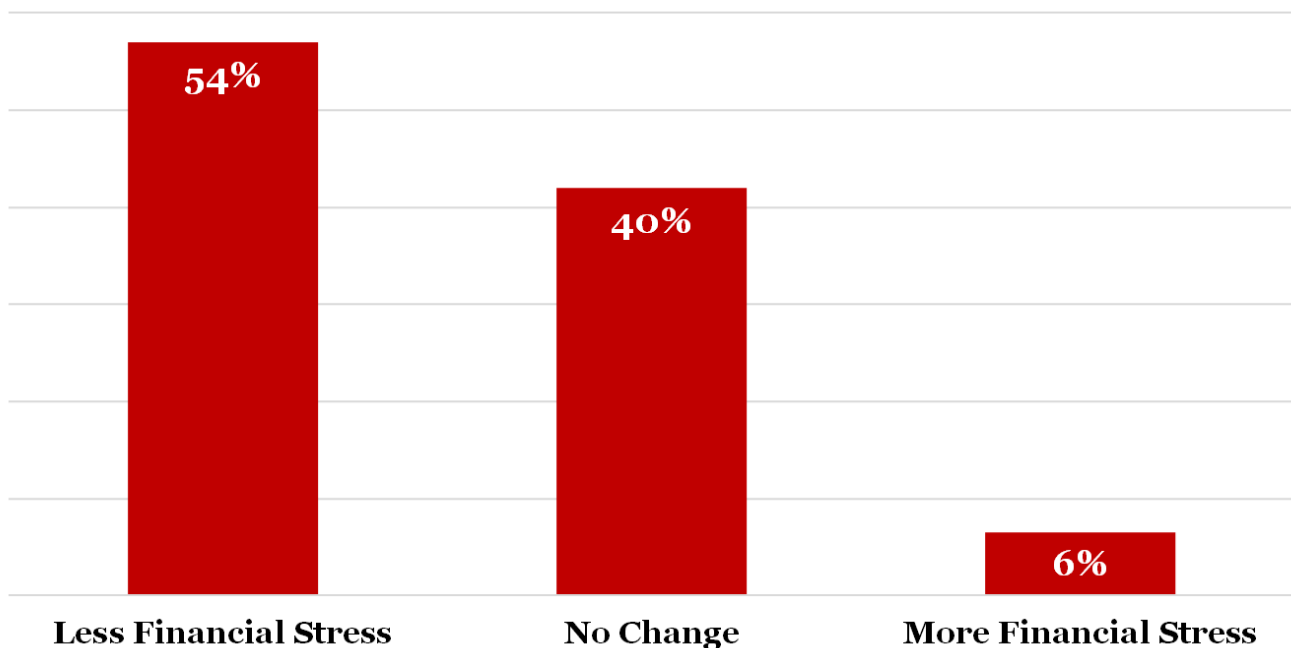


Figure 3: Since joining the LRRP, how often do you experience worry or stress about money?

Participants consistently described the program as a critical source of support, reflecting broader themes of financial relief, stability, and crisis prevention. Many emphasized a sense of security and reassurance, using phrases such as **“this program threw me a lifeline”** and highlighting the ability to **“stay rooted in the community.”**

For some, the LRRP helped them remain in their homes; for others, it enhanced an overall sense of wellbeing and security or supported plans to pass their home down to future generations. Nearly all participants described ongoing financial stress to some degree, while also noting the program’s role in alleviating some of that anxiety.

Participants also expressed ongoing concerns about losing their homes, broader changes within their communities, and the growing influence of developers. Many described visible neighborhood shifts, noting that **“now half the houses are rentals”** and that these changes are **“destroying the fabric**

of our community.” Alongside these concerns, participants described feelings of being “**left behind**” and fears of displacement, not only for themselves but for their neighbors as well. There were also community pride and reference to strong roots.

“Our homes in the West End are old, unique, and historic ...these neighborhoods save Atlanta from looking like Anywhere, USA.”

We found that after joining the LRRP program, these fears were less acute to participants. Many discussed the program allowing them to keep a sense of themselves, their “dignity” and ability to stay in their community. As the majority of participants were retired, there was also an appreciation for making “a long life [worth] living”, as one participant described it, less stressful.

Anxiety around 2030 Funding Deadline

Despite relief and gratitude towards and LRRP program, there was also growing anxiety about the programs potential 2030 end date. Participants described increasing worry about rising costs and the possibility of losing their homes once support ends. Some noted they “**become increasingly anxious**” as 2030 approaches. The phrasing made it seem as though participants saw the 2030 deadline not just as a potential setback but a precipice, using phrases such as “as we inch closer to 2030”, “prepare for the jump in 2030”, and “I tear up at what is to come next.” These findings highlight the potential impact of the end of the funding deadline.

Community and Outreach

Participants also highlighted the importance of strong community networks in navigating financial challenges. Faith-based organizations, family members, and neighbors often provide critical support, from helping with groceries and utility bills to sharing food. This sense of community support also extended to program awareness, with the primary way **participants learned about the program** was through word of mouth (44%), followed by the Atlanta Beltline Partnership website (31%) and flyers (25%).

“I don’t gatekeep, I share resources...I want to help neighbors.” B.

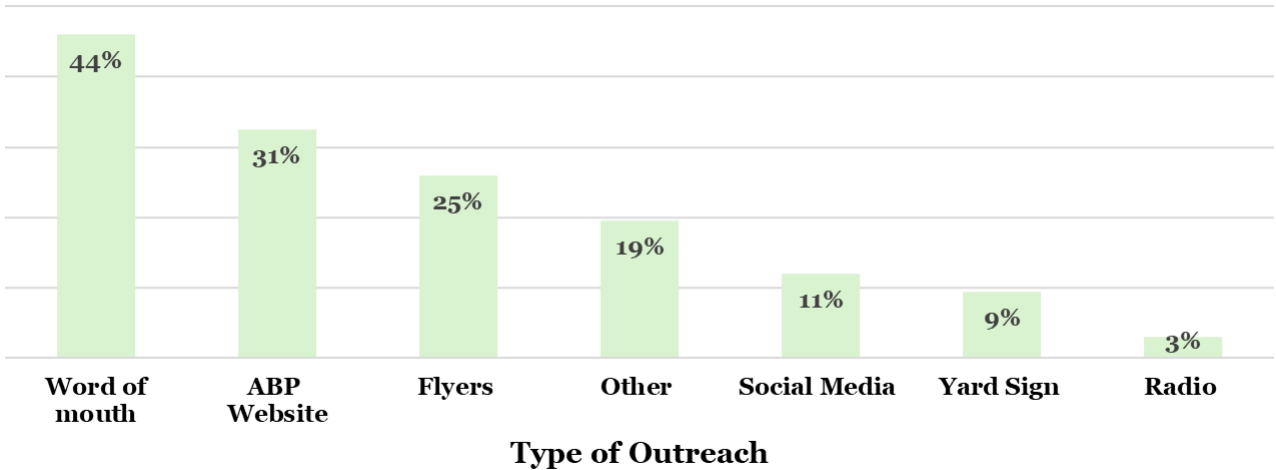


Figure 4: How did you learn about the LRRP?

B. CONCLUSIONS

This formative program evaluation had the following six SMAARTIE outcome objectives (See the Evaluation Project Overview for additional information about the Outcome Objectives):

Outcome Objective	Met	Partially Met	Not Met	Evidence
#1a: By March 2026, 70% of current LRRP participants who have received property tax payments will have completed a program evaluation survey.	X			Objective #1a was met because roughly 76% of current LRRP participants who received property tax payments responded to the program evaluation survey.
#1b: By the end of March 2026, 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report less worry about losing their homes after joining LRRP.	X			Objective #1b was met because 54% of current LRRP participants reported less worry about losing their homes after joining LRRP.
#1c: By the end of March 2026, 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report that having their property taxes paid has helped them plan better for their future (i.e. feeling financially secure, having access to more resources).		X		Objective #1c was partially met because 50% of participants felt more financially secure, but only 38% of participants said they have access to more resources.
#1d: By the end of March 2026, 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report experiencing less worry or stress about money than they did before joining the LRRP.	X			Objective #1d was met because 65% of participants reported experiencing less worry or stress about money than they did before joining the LRRP.
#1e: By the end of March 2026, current LRRP participants will report no longer struggling to pay for at least 3 of 5 metrics including: groceries or food, healthcare or prescriptions, home repairs or maintenance, transportation, utilities or bills after joining the LRRP.		X		Objective #1e was met because LRRP participants no longer struggled with paying more than three out of five metrics.

Effective LRRP Program Elements

Overall, the LRRP helped address and alleviate fears related to financial and housing instability. The LRRP's assistance with paying rising property taxes improved participants' financial and emotional wellness and, subsequently, their quality of life. For some participants, it addressed the immediate concern of losing housing. For others, it allowed planning for longer-term financial goals and building generational wealth. Participants also shared gratitude over the LRRP and encouraged further program outreach.

Additionally, the LRRP improved quality of life by allowing some participants to not have to compromise their health to keep up with home repairs. Participants reported multiple tradeoffs they had to make to keep their home before the program, including foregoing doctor appointments and time with family. The LRRP program reduced this burden for participants, thereby improving emotional and financial well-being.

Potential Areas for LRRP Improvement

Despite the support from the LRRP, many participants continued to struggle to pay for home repairs due to the enormity and complexity of maintaining their historic homes. Additionally, communal displacement has altered the landscape and homeowners' familiarity with one another in the Atlanta Beltline neighborhoods.

Participants expressed mistrust towards developers and fears of being displaced from their communities. This loss of community has compromised LRRP participants' quality of life, particularly by diminishing their social and emotional well-being. Currently, LRRP does not have a community-building initiative in place to counteract these negative effects on participants' quality of life. Community gathering is also essential for program outreach, since most participants learn about the LRRP program through word of mouth.

For all these reasons, the thought of LRRP ending in 2030 caused distress among most of the program participants. Currently, LRRP is a lifeline for its participants. It prevents the immediate crisis of losing one's home, eases emotional and financial stress, and keeps participants connected to their community.

C. RECOMMENDATIONS

Survey and focus group data were analyzed to produce findings and conclusions, which then informed the development of data-driven recommendations. The recommendations developed by the evaluation team are meant to support both LRRP and its participants.

These recommendations were categorized in a Significance, Opportunity, Resources, and Knowledge (SORK) Table (see Appendix 4.2a-c), which is used to prioritize program evaluation recommendations by urgency and feasibility. To begin, each evaluation team member independently rated the urgency and feasibility of each recommendation on a scale of 1-4, where 1 indicated the lowest level of urgency/feasibility, and 4 indicated the highest level of urgency/feasibility. Individual scores were recorded on SORK Table 1 (Appendix 4.2a) while group averages were recorded on SORK Table 2 (Appendix 4.2b).

In the last step, recommendations were mapped to a 2x2 Urgency and Feasibility table (Appendix 4.2c) based on group average scores. The scores in this table determined the priority order of the recommendations listed below.

Data-Driven Recommendations

1. Incentivize and enhance outreach strategies to recruit more LRRP participants

Based on our evaluation findings, most current LRRP participants joined the program through word-of-mouth, the Atlanta Beltline Partnership website, and flyers. Since these recruitment channels proved to be most effective, we recommend strengthening these pathways to improve the LRRP's ability to reach as many eligible participants as possible.

We recommend that the Atlanta Beltline Partnership offers incentives to current participants for word-of-mouth referrals to the program. Additionally, we suggest that the LRRP work with community and neighborhood groups such as the neighborhood associations, senior centers, and the Housing Authority of Fulton County to increase program publicity. More frequent distribution of flyers in eligible Westside and Southside Beltline neighborhoods could also enhance recruitment.

2. Increase community engagement between the Atlanta Beltline Partnership and LRRP participants and neighborhoods

Survey and focus group findings indicated that LRRP participants are seeking community connection. As their neighborhoods change, LRRP residents do not always know their neighbors or have the opportunity to connect with one another through self-organized events like block parties. Additionally, some LRRP participants were wary of participating in the program before joining because they were unfamiliar with the program and the Atlanta Beltline Partnership.

We recommend increasing community engagement between the Atlanta Beltline Partnership and the LRRP neighborhoods and communities to build trust between the two entities. We recommend the LRRP host community events, like block parties, to provide opportunities for neighbors to interact with one another, building stronger communities and social networks for LRRP participants. These community events would also allow the Atlanta Beltline Partnership to interact and build rapport with legacy residents.

3. Extend the LRRP beyond 2030 to improve legacy resident quality of life and reduce displacement, if feasible

LRRP participants expressed how helpful and relieving the property tax payments provided by the LRRP have been in reducing stress and worry about money. Participants also made it clear how much their homes and neighborhoods mean to them, and that they are not interested in leaving their places of residence.

As the city of Atlanta and the Beltline continue to expand, many legacy residents notice changes in their neighborhoods. Without the continuation of the program, legacy residents may be at risk of being priced out or displaced. It is important to extend the LRRP to continue to help legacy residents maintain financial and housing stability and well-being.

If the Atlanta Beltline Partnership is unable to obtain funding to continue the LRRP past 2030, we recommend that the program hosts information sessions to prepare participants for the potential lack of property tax assistance.

4. Expand the scope of the LRRP to assist with home repairs and maintenance, if feasible

The current financial support provided by the LRRP is limited to partial subsidization of property tax payments. A large percentage of LRRP participants indicate that they find it difficult to pay for home repairs or maintenance. The LRRP already supports participants through the Empower Workshops and by offering home repair and maintenance resource lists to residents. By expanding the scope of the LRRP to support participants financially with home repairs, the program can have a larger positive impact on participant well-being.

D. LIMITATIONS

This program evaluation had three main limitations: the data-collection tools, procedures, and the overall timeline.

Firstly, all data collection tools for this program evaluation (i.e., quotes from the focus group transcripts and survey) were created before the evaluation began. As a result, the questions in the focus group and survey were not directly related to the program evaluation question about LRRP participants' quality of life. Additionally, our team was only provided with quotes from the focus group transcripts, limiting the quantity data for analysis. Therefore, the evaluation team had to use and prioritize responses from the focus group and survey questions that were adjacent to the main evaluation question.

Secondly, the survey was administered online and in person. In-person data collection (i.e., canvassing) lasted for only two days. The online survey, however, was available for months. As a result, the evaluation team reached fewer people without internet access. Thus, fewer perspectives were gathered about LRRP's impact on participants' quality of life.

Thirdly, the online survey was administered in three waves and edited after the first wave. As a result, questions about race and health insurance were only answered in waves two and three. Lastly, a short academic semester limited the evaluation timeline, including the time frame to collect and analyze data.

E. CONTRIBUTIONS TO PUBLIC HEALTH

Our findings show that the LRRP participants are facing the risk of displacement due to the gentrification brought about by the Beltline. As home values and property taxes rise, it makes it increasingly difficult for homeowners, many of whom are retired and living on fixed income, to keep up with the increasing prices. This leads to housing instability, which has been linked to both mental and physical outcomes associated with chronic stress, isolation, and depression (Carrere, 2022).

Our report highlights the meaningful impact the LRRP is making on individuals, communities, and the city of Atlanta. Additionally, our findings reinforce the need for continued funding for the LRRP program past 2030.

The focus on housing instability aligns with public health priorities listed by Healthy People 2030; these include Economic Stability as well as Neighborhoods and Built Environment as key social determinants of health (Healthy People, 2030). By listening to the voices of the participants, we hope to contribute this report to public health by showing how critical it is to protect and foster these communities, and the residents who make it home.

PART II

F. EVALUATION PROJECT OVERVIEW

The *Legacy Resident Retention Program* (LRRP), which is sponsored by the Atlanta Beltline Partnership (ABP), was developed with a goal of aiding long-term (legacy) homeowners living in neighborhoods surrounding the Atlanta Beltline to address the effects of gentrification.

The acronym SMAART[IE] stands for Specific, Measurable, Ambitious, Achievable, Relevant, Time-Limited, and, in some cases, Inclusive and/or Equitable. A fully compliant SMAARTIE Outcome Objective is rigorous and defines the minimum level of success in accomplishing a Program Goal, Program Objective, or Process Objective (Hagen, 2024, Reading Packet B, p.3). As described above in the report Summary and the Project Overview sections, the Program Objective below was provided by the community partner and the associated SMAARTIE outcome objectives were constructed by the program evaluation team.

LRRP Program Objective and SMAART[IE] Outcome Objectives

LRRP Program Objective #1: Improve the quality of life of legacy homeowners in designated Westside and Southside Beltline subareas.

Outcome Objective #1a: By March 2026, 70% of current LRRP participants who have received property tax payments will have completed a program evaluation survey.

Outcome Objective #1b: By the end of March 2026, 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report less worry about losing their homes after joining LRRP.

Outcome Objective #1c: By the end of March 2026, 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report that having their property taxes paid has helped them plan better for their future (i.e. feeling financially secure, having access to more resources).

Outcome Objective #1d: By the end of March 2026, 50% or more of current LRRP participants will report experiencing less worry or stress about money than they did before joining the LRRP.

Outcome Objective #1e: By the end of March 2026, current LRRP participants will report no longer struggling to pay for at least 3 of 5 metrics including: groceries or food, healthcare or prescriptions, home repairs or maintenance, transportation, utilities or bills after joining the LRRP.

This evaluation was needed to assess the current impact of the LRRP on its participants to inform program improvement. Specifically, the ABP, in partnership with public health consultant, Tiarra Murphy, aimed to measure the extent to which participation in the LRRP had influenced participants' quality of life. In addition, the ABP was interested in examining whether program impacts vary across participant demographic groups.

Program activities included fundraising, participant recruitment, building relationships with legacy residents, and direct property tax payments. Under the program, participants pay property taxes at their 2019 level, while the LRRP covers any tax increases through 2030 (Atlanta Beltline, Inc., 2025).

Activities relevant to this evaluation included both qualitative and quantitative components. The ABP and Ms. Murphy have already conducted focus groups with LRRP participants, and our team was provided quotes from the focus group transcripts to analyze.

In addition, the ABP had created and begun distributing a quantitative survey to LRRP participants. To date, approximately half of all LRRP participants (n=277) have completed the survey.

This evaluation was needed to reach LRRP participants whose survey responses are missing. Our evaluation team supported survey data collection through community-based canvassing efforts to reach participants who have not yet responded digitally. The resulting quantitative survey data was analyzed by our evaluation team and used to develop strategies to reach these respondents in the future.

The findings and recommendations from this evaluation **identify effective elements of the LRRP, as well as areas for potential improvement.**

Project Shareholders

Project shareholders engaged in this evaluation are listed in the table below. See Glossary and Appendix 3.1 for more information regarding the shareholders included in this evaluation.

Name	Role	Evaluation Project Role
Michael Davis	Deputy Executive Director at Atlanta Beltline Partnership	The Primary Intended User (PIU) of this evaluation
Marian Davis	Empower Program Manager at Atlanta Beltline Partnership	A key shareholder in this evaluation who has the authority to implement program changes
Tiarra Murphy	Program Evaluation Consultant	Evaluation shareholder who oversees this program evaluation and will make programmatic recommendations based on evaluation findings
Desarai King	Research and Project Support Consultant	Evaluation shareholder supporting this evaluation who will make programmatic recommendations based on evaluation findings
Current LRRP participants	N/A	Evaluation shareholders who contributed focus group data and survey responses for the purposes of this evaluation
Future LRRP participants	N/A	Program shareholders who may be affected by program improvements and recruitment efforts informed by the evaluation
Beltline Donors	N/A	Organization shareholders who support the LRRP through philanthropic donations

G. LITERATURE REVIEW

Atlanta has a long history of gentrification and racialized housing policies. Gentrification is the process in which “wealthier individuals move into a previously lower-income neighborhood, leading to rising property values and rents, often displacing long-term residents” (“What is gentrification,” n.d.).

Examples of Atlanta’s racialized housing and gentrification policies include redlining practices and large developments such as preparations for the 1996 Olympics and construction of the Hartsfield-Jackson Atlanta International Airport (Williams, 2022).

The city has also experienced substantial population growth, with the number of residents more than doubling between 1990 and 2025. Alongside this population increase, Atlanta has undergone significant demographic shifts. Between 2000 and 2025, White residents accounted for approximately 50% of new residents, while the Black population declined during the same time period (Atlanta Regional Commission, 2025).

Although new development is visible throughout the city, few projects have been as widely recognized or impactful as the Atlanta Beltline. The Beltline is a revitalized 22-mile multi-use trail developed from a former railroad loop that passes through 45 Atlanta neighborhoods (Oakley, 2017). Figure 1 below highlights the Atlanta Beltline subareas. Outlined subareas are LRRP eligible.

Since construction began in 2006, the Beltline has introduced numerous benefits, including expanded greenspace, improved walkability, and increased access to shops and restaurants.

However, **the development of the Beltline has also contributed to rising property values and gentrification, placing long-term residents at increased risk of displacement due to rising housing costs.** Homes located near the Beltline appreciated by approximately 60% between 2012 and 2015, compared to an appreciation rate closer to 30% across the rest of Atlanta (Gugiliotta, 2020).

As home values increase, property taxes also rise, making it increasingly difficult for existing homeowners to afford their homes. These effects are especially pronounced for legacy homeowners in Westside and Southside neighborhoods, many of whom are older adults living in historically lower-income communities (Beltline, Inc., 2018). Area median income (AMI) is commonly used as a benchmark to describe household income relative to the median income within a given geographic area (Atlanta Beltline, Inc. 2024).

Nearly one-quarter of Beltline legacy homeowners in Westside and Southside neighborhoods earn less than 80% of AMI, further increasing their risk of being priced out of their homes. Rising property taxes can affect household spending by diverting limited financial resources away from essential needs such as food, transportation, and medications, thereby increasing the risk of housing instability.

Housing instability has been closely linked to both mental and physical health outcomes and is associated with chronic stress, social isolation, and depression (Carrere, 2022). In addition, witnessing neighbors being displaced from their homes can heighten fear of displacement among remaining residents and erode long-standing social networks and community cohesion (Mitchell, 2025).

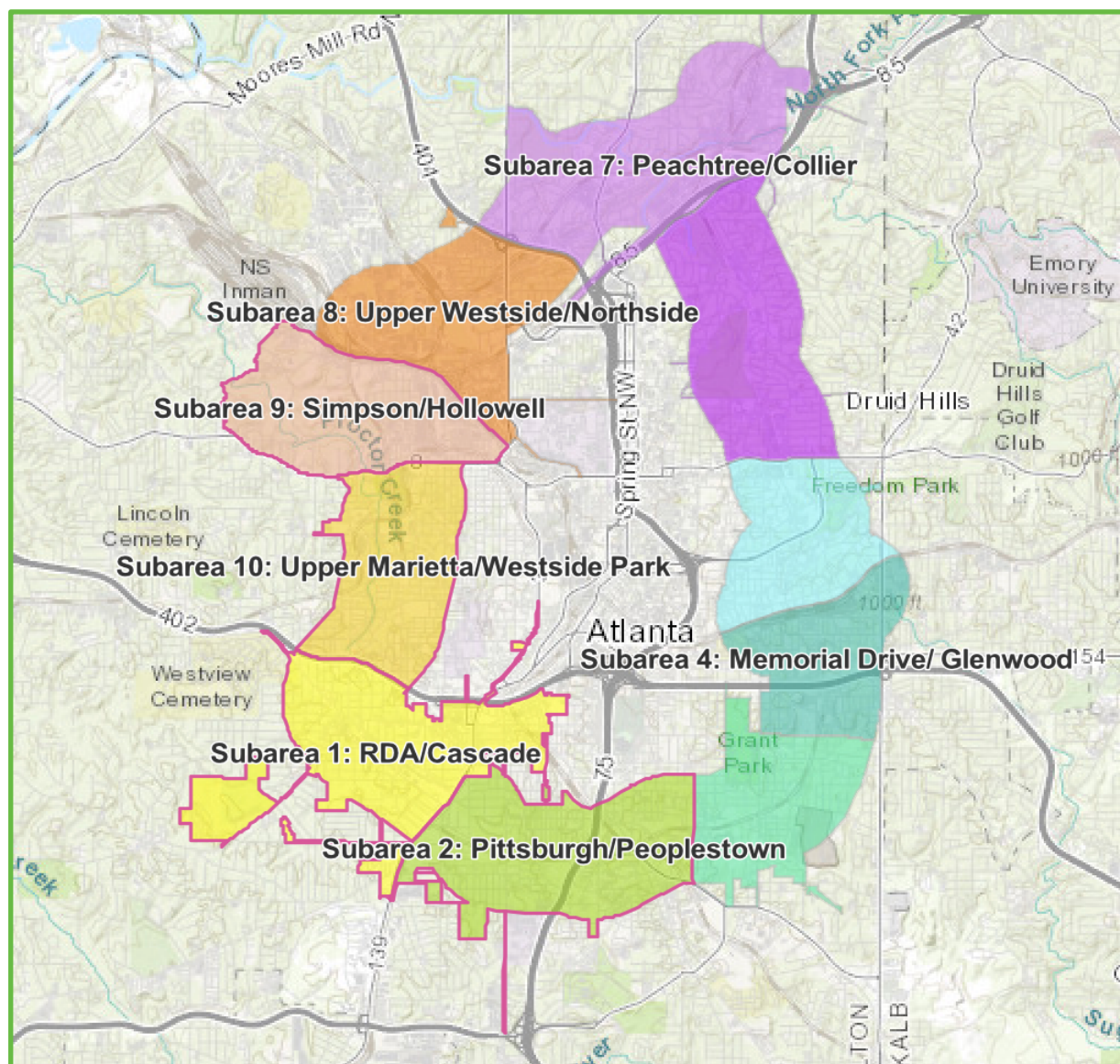


Figure 1: *Legacy Resident Retention Program Subareas with LRRP Eligible Subareas Outlined*

Note: Reprinted from “Legacy Resident Retention Program Subarea Lookup” (Atlanta Beltline, Inc., n.d., retrieved February 4, 2026, from <https://abi.maps.arcgis.com/apps/instant/lookup/index.html?appid=a62ef86186e3497dac69935ae9f839aa>)

These outcomes represent unintended but significant consequences of gentrification associated with large-scale urban development initiatives such as the Beltline, and they have direct implications for residents’ overall quality of life.

In response to these challenges, initiatives have been implemented to help residents remain in their homes, including the *Legacy Resident Retention Program* (LRRP). The LRRP provides property tax assistance to eligible long-term homeowners living in the Westside and Southside Beltline neighborhoods. **By reducing the financial burden associated with rising property taxes, the LRRP aims to promote housing stability, protect residents’ quality of life, and support opportunities for long-term economic security and generational wealth**

H. PROGRAM MODELS

Logic Model

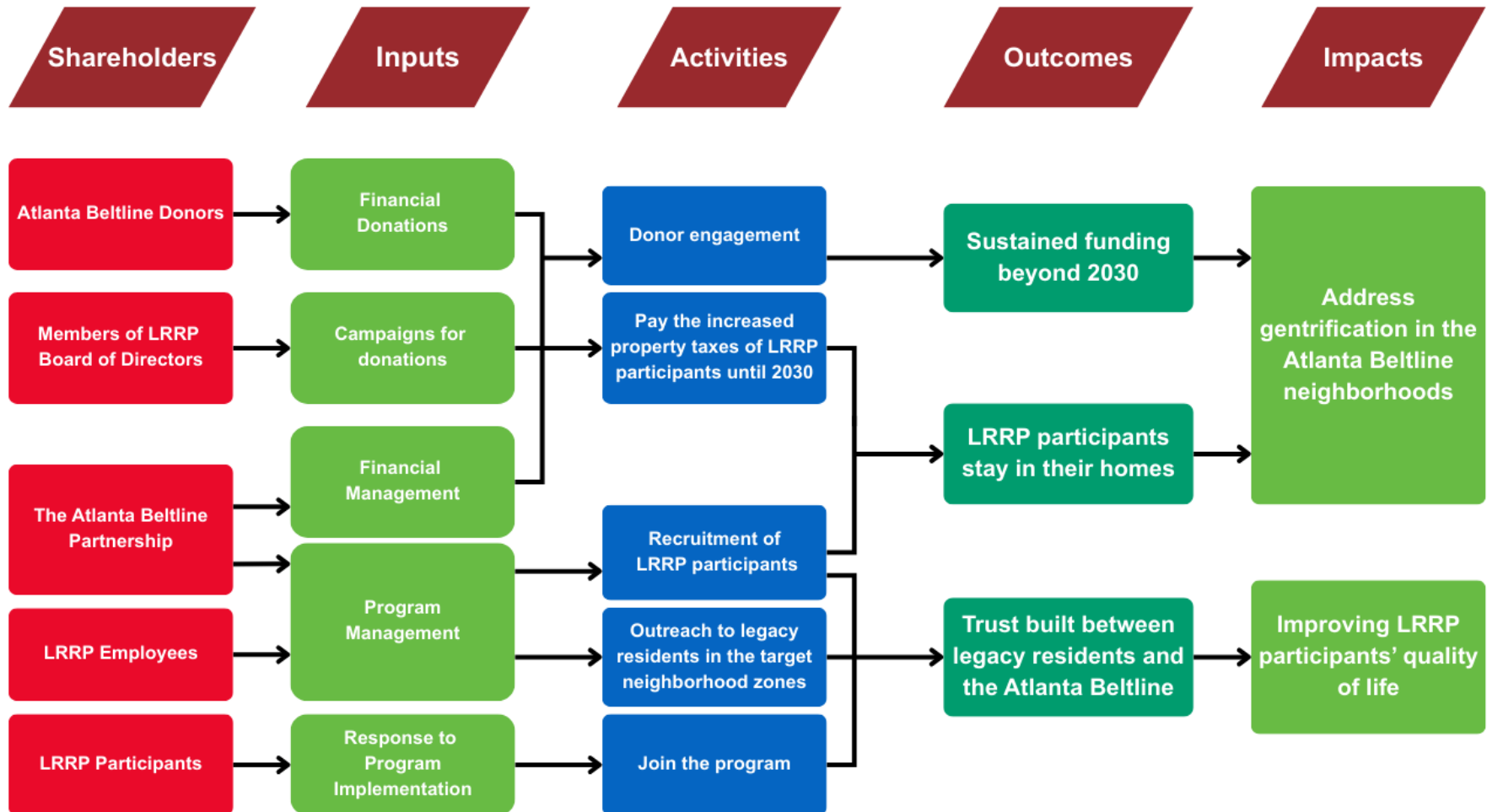
Logic models illustrate key components of an organization or program and show how those components are connected (Hagen, 2024, Reading Packet C, p.9). In the context of evaluation, a logic model outlines the relationships between different parts of a program lead to outcomes and impacts.

By visually organizing these elements, the logic model makes the program's structure and processes more transparent, allowing its features to be clearly designed, implemented, and measured. The following logic model shows how LRRPs shareholders influence different inputs, in turn leading to the programs five core activities, followed by the programs intended outputs and impact. The flow of the model (see Figure 1 below) shows how the components of the program work together to create the LRRP program and its goals.

Concept Map

A concept map is a visual representation of the key ideas, assumptions, and relationships that shape how a program is understood and implemented. Rather than listing components in isolation, it highlights the relationships between resources, activities, contextual factors, and expected impacts. In the context of this evaluation, the concept map (see Figure 2 below) serves as a tool to clarify the LRRP's underlying logic, align shareholders around a shared understanding of its purpose, and provide a foundation for examining whether and how the program influences participant quality of life.

Legacy Residency Retention Program (LRRP) Logic Model



The Legacy Residency Retention Program (LRRP) logic model is organized into five columns arranged from left to right: 1) Shareholders, 2) Inputs, 3) Activities, 4) Outcomes, and 5) Impacts. **The model visually represents how shareholders and their inputs form program activities, which lead to outcomes and, finally, LRRP's overall impacts. Arrows connect each column, demonstrating this logical progression from shareholders to final impacts.**

Shareholders in the first column provide tangible or intangible resources, **inputs (see second column)**, which provide support for **activities (see third column)**. Activities, if they are successful, will lead to changes for the individuals or organizations that participated directly in those activities, we call those **outcomes (see fourth column)**. If outcomes are as we desire them to be, they can eventually lead downstream to a larger societal level ripple effect, called **impacts (see fifth column)**.

For the LRRP, **their shareholders include the Atlanta Beltline Donors**, who provide **financial donations as an input**, the members of the LRRP board of directors, which provide the input of leadership with campaigns for donations, and the Atlanta Beltline Partnership, which provide the inputs of financial and program management. The LRRP employees also provide financial management as an input, and then the LRRP participants' input is the response to program implementation.

Those inputs, as noted above, **provide support for programmatic activities of the LRRP program**. Collectively, financial donations, campaigns to raise donations, and financial management **provide the necessary resources for the activities** of donor engagement and paying the increased property taxes of LRRP participants until 2030.

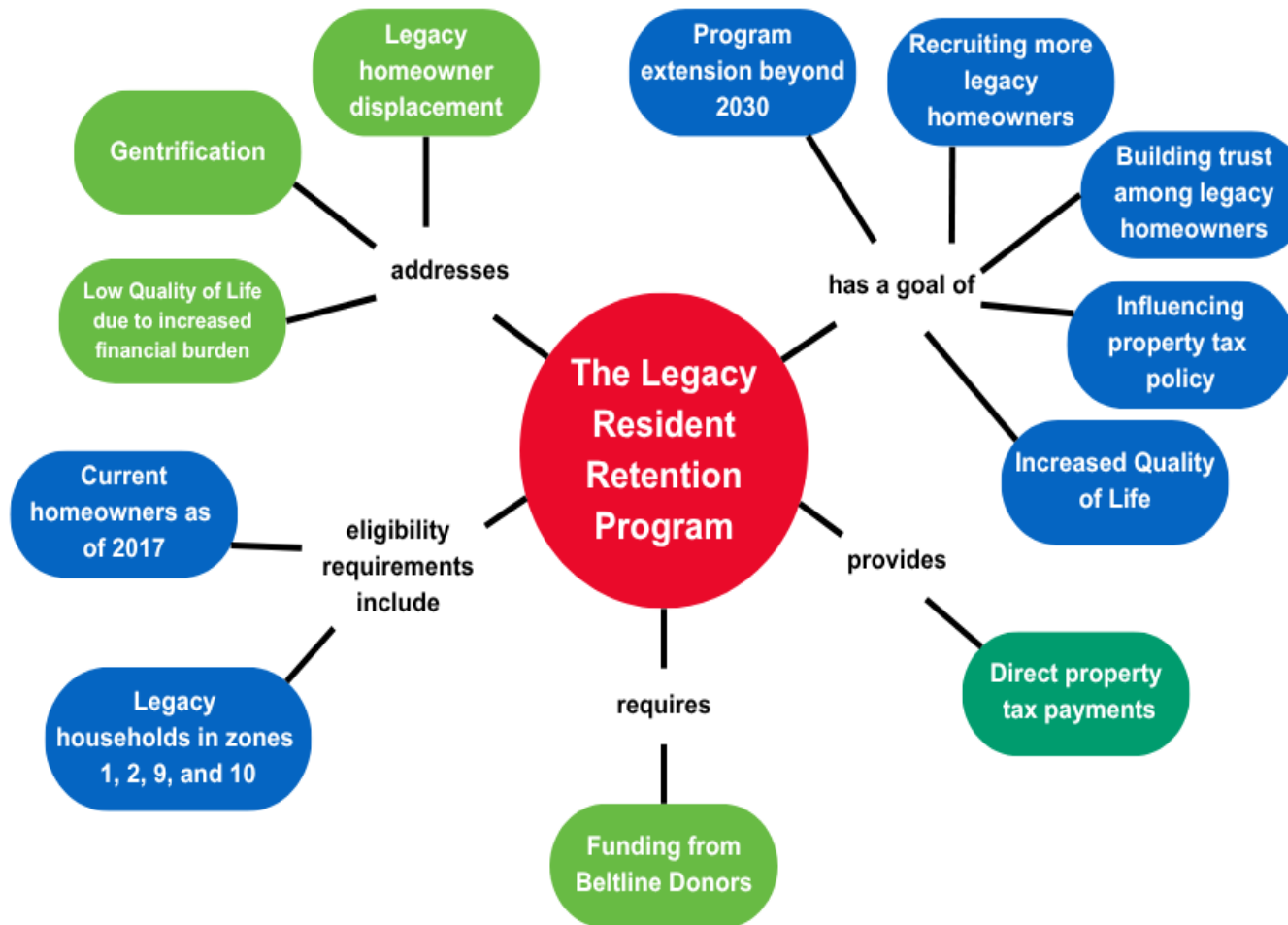
The fourth input, program management, provides the resources for the activities of recruitment of LRRP participants, and outreach to legacy residents in the target neighborhood zones. The final input, provided by the LRRP participants, is responding to program implementation, which supports the activity of joining the LRRP program. **Those activities (third column) support outcomes.**

The activity of donor engagement, if successful, **will lead to the outcome (fourth column)** of sustained funding beyond 2030. The activity of paying increased property taxes of LRRP participants and the activity of recruiting LRRP participants, will collectively **lead to the outcome** of LRRP participants staying in their homes.

The last three activities are recruitment of LRRP participants, outreach to legacy residents in target neighborhoods, and the act of joining the program. **These activities collectively lead to the desired outcome** of building trust between legacy residents and the Atlanta Beltline.

The first two outcomes (fourth column) of sustained funding beyond 2030, and LRRP participants staying in their homes, will independently **lead to the impact (fifth column)** of addressing gentrification in the Atlanta Beltline Neighborhoods. **The third outcome**, building trust between legacy residents and the Atlanta Beltline, **will lead to the downstream impact of improving LRRP participants' quality of life.**

Legacy Resident Retention Program (LRRP) Concept Map



PART III

I. METHODOLOGY

Data Collection Consultant Interview

The Data Collection Consultant Interview (DCCI) was conducted on February 5th, 2026, with Ms. Tiarra Murphy, the LRRP Program Evaluation Consultant, to inform our data collection protocol and further our understanding of LRRP's goals (see Appendix 1.1 for full DCCI protocol).

The DCCI was conducted via Zoom with the whole evaluation team present, with one member leading the interview. A semi-structured interview guide was created by the team and followed by the interviewer (see Appendix 2.1 for the full DDCI interview guide). Detailed notes were taken by the other four team members and reviewed collectively. Data from the DCCI was used to craft a primary data collection plan.

Survey Data Collection

The survey tool (see Appendix 2.3) used to evaluate the LRRP was provided to Team Axolotl by Ms. Tiarra Murphy. The survey included questions about LRRP participant experiences with the program, and its impact on their quality of life. The evaluation team then conducted data collection by canvassing at homes of LRRP participants in specified homes around the Atlanta Beltline on March 20th, 2026 and March 21st, 2026.

These participants were identified for in-person data collection as they had not already completed the digital survey. The goal was to make sure they were still represented when assessing LRRP's impact on participants' quality of life (see Appendix 2.3 for full data collection protocol).

Data Collection Crosswalk

To ensure alignment between the evaluation goal of understanding whether the LRRP impacted participants' quality of life and the data collection methods used, the evaluation team developed a Data Collection Crosswalk (see Appendix 4.1). This ensures a clear link between the evaluation objectives and the methods used to measure them.

Inclusive Evaluation Practices

To ensure a multi-cultural and equitable perspective while conducting this evaluation, Team Axolotl also created an inclusive evaluation practice table (see Appendix 4.3).

Recommendations Generation

After data analysis, conclusions were drawn from project findings. These conclusions and their associated data-driven recommendations were entered on a "SORK Table" (See Appendix 4, SORK Table 1). After developing conclusions, it is essential to provide organizational shareholders with the most important and feasible recommendations drawn from those conclusions. SORK Tables are a process for ranking those recommendations (Hagen, 2024, Reading Packet G, p.13).

Using a standardized scale, each recommendation included on the SORK Table was individually and separately assessed by each member of the team for Importance (1=Not Important; 2=Low Importance; 3=Important; 4=Very Important) and for Feasibility (1=Not Feasible; 2=Low Feasibility; 3=Feasible; 4=Very Feasible).

The mean of team scores were then calculated for each recommendation (see Appendix 4, SORK Table 2). Each recommendation was entered into the appropriate cell of a 2x2 recommendations table based on the intersection of their respective Importance and Feasibility scores (see Appendix 4, SORK Table 3), helping to establish the priority order of the recommendations we made.

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APPENDICES

APPENDIX 1

Appendix 1.1: Data Collection Consultant Interview (DCCI) Protocol

Purpose of the Data Collection Consultant Interview

The purpose of the Data Collection Consultant Interview was to (a) frame the evaluation team's understanding of the LRRP run by the Atlanta Beltline Partnership, (b) inform the team about previous evaluation efforts, and (c) guide the focus and methods of data collection used in the current evaluation.

Identification of Data Collection Consultant

Inclusion criteria for selecting key informants included: knowledge and experience of the LRRP, the Atlanta Beltline Partnership, and the steps that have already been taken in evaluating this program. There were no exclusion criteria.

The data collection consultant included in this evaluation was Tiarra Murphy. Tiarra Murphy is a Program Evaluation Consultant leading the evaluation of the LRRP on behalf of the Atlanta Beltline Partnership. She holds a bachelor's degree in psychology and a master's degree in public health. Ms. Murphy began working on this program evaluation in 2024 and specializes in program evaluation and coordination.

Recruitment Methods

Purposive sampling was used to recruit key informants. The evaluation team was first connected to Tiarra Murphy through the Program Evaluation course at Emory University. Ms. Murphy volunteered as a data collection consultant, and therefore Team Axolotl did not need to engage in active recruitment (see Appendix 2.1). Due to her role as program evaluation consultant hired by the Atlanta Beltline Partnership, she was well positioned to provide background information on the program and previous evaluation activities.

Data Collection Methods

Data from the data collection consultant was collected using a semi-structured interview guide. A semi-structured interview design was selected to allow Team Axolotl to ask the consultant open-ended questions and to capture more detail and nuance.

The creation of the semi-structured interview guide was an iterative process. Multiple group members brainstormed potential questions. The interview guide was then more formally drafted by one team member and then refined by another team member.

The remaining three team members reviewed the interview guide as a form of pre-testing to ensure the questions were clear and logically ordered. While pre-testing the guide with fellow MPH students was sufficient given the time constraints, it would be preferable to pre-test the guide with a volunteer more similar to the data collection consultant.

The interview guide included questions designed to clarify the evaluation question, the status of the survey instruments the evaluation team planned to use, the procedures related to canvassing, and best practices for interacting with potential participants (see Appendix 2.1). The consultant provided verbal consent to participate in the interview and to allow the interview to be audio-recorded by Team Axolotl.

Data Analysis Plan

Data from the DCCI were analyzed using open coding to identify key themes that informed the development of the data collection protocol for the evaluation.

Quality Control

The data collection consultant interview was conducted over Zoom. All five members of Team Axolotl were present. One group member verbally conducted the interview, while the other group members took notes and asked follow-up questions when needed.

The interview was recorded and stored in the Zoom cloud. Zoom automatically produced a written transcript of the interview, which was then used to refer to when developing the data collection protocol and data collection tool. The data collection consultant interview Zoom recording will be permanently deleted at the end of this Program Evaluation course in May 2026.

Triangulation

Investigator triangulation was used to ensure the validity of key informant interviews. All team members were present at the group DCCI and participated in the analysis process. By involving all team members in the data collection and analysis process and reaching a group consensus, a form of investigator triangulation, there was an increased likelihood of accurate findings. (Hagen, 2024, Reading Packet D, p. 48).

Appendix 1.2: Survey Data Collection Protocol

Purpose of Canvassing

The purpose of data collection was to collect survey responses from participants in the Legacy Resident Retention Program (LRRP) who had not completed the digital survey. Some LRRP participants may experience barriers to completing an online survey, including limited access to technology or internet service, or limited familiarity with digital platforms. Therefore, our data collection method was an in-person survey that was administered through canvassing.

By canvassing in person, we aimed to reduce these access barriers and provide the opportunity for participants to complete the survey with assistance from the evaluation team.

The goal of canvassing is to ensure that the perspectives of as many LRRP participants as possible are represented in the evaluation data. Our team canvassed over two days to maximize participation on Friday, March 20th and Saturday, March 21st, 2026. However, due to time and capacity constraints, it was not possible for all eligible participants to be reached.

Recruitment and Participant Selection

Eligible participants were required to meet the following inclusion criteria:

- Be an enrolled participant in the LRRP.
- Have not previously completed the LRRP survey through the digital survey platform.

There were no exclusion criteria.

Although individuals who had already completed the survey were excluded from canvassing, their previously submitted responses will still be included in the overall evaluation dataset.

Participants selected for canvassing were identified by the Atlanta Beltline Partnership through a comparison of the LRRP enrollment list and Qualtrics survey completion data. This process identified LRRP participants who had not yet submitted a survey response. Prior to the canvassing days, the Atlanta Beltline Partnership staff member coordinating the evaluation, Tiarra Murphy, contacted selected participants to inform them that canvassing would occur, and ask participants if there is a convenient time for the canvassing team to visit their residence.

Participants were then organized by geographic location and preferred visitation times to allow canvassing teams to efficiently visit households within the same area and honor any requested appointment windows.

Data Collection Procedures

The data collection tool was the LRRP participant survey (see Appendix 2.2). This same survey has been distributed before and pre-tested for data collection. During canvassing visits, participants completed the survey with assistance from members of the evaluation team using tablet devices.

Data collection occurred across two canvassing days, one weekday and one weekend day. This was chosen in order to reach participants with different work schedules and availability. At the start of each canvassing day, the evaluation team met at the Atlanta Beltline Partnership office. Team members were divided into small groups of at least three individuals, including at least one Atlanta Beltline Partnership community partner.

Each team was provided with:

- A list of assigned households, participant names, and any requested visit times
- Identifying t-shirts indicating affiliation with the LRRP evaluation
- Clipboards and paper surveys to administer and record survey responses

Within each team, roles were assigned to ensure efficient and safe data collection. One team member verbally guided the participant through the survey questions, another recorded responses on the tablet device, and another monitored the surrounding environment to ensure team safety during the canvassing process. Teams then traveled to their assigned geographic areas to begin household visits.

Data Analysis

All survey responses collected during the past year, including responses from the digital survey and those obtained through canvassing, were included in our analysis. The analysis focuses on survey items related to participants' quality of life to assess the perceived impact of the LRRP.

Closed-ended survey questions were analyzed using descriptive statistics, including measures of central tendency (mean, median, and mode). Responses were compared across demographic subgroups to identify potential differences in reported quality of life among participants.

Open-ended survey responses were coded and analyzed using thematic analysis to identify recurring concepts related to participants' experiences with the LRRP. After the survey analysis is complete, quotes from the focus groups transcripts were reviewed to identify responses that support and contextualize key survey findings.

Quality Control

Several procedures were implemented to ensure quality control throughout the data collection, entry, management, and analysis processes. Prior to canvassing, all evaluation team members were trained on the survey instrument, canvassing procedures, and standardized protocols for interacting with participants and recording responses. This training helped ensure that the survey was administered consistently across canvassing teams and that participants received the same explanations and instructions.

During data collection, survey responses were either entered directly into tablet devices using the Qualtrics survey platform. If the survey was conducted on paper, it was digitally inputted after canvassing. Team members verified responses with participants as they conducted the survey to ensure that answers are accurately recorded.

Following data collection, the dataset was reviewed for completeness and accuracy. Data cleaning procedures included checking for missing values, inconsistent responses, and duplicate entries. Any identified discrepancies were reviewed by the evaluation team and resolved.

For qualitative data, open-ended responses were coded using a structured coding process. Coding decisions and theme development were discussed among evaluation team members to ensure consistency in interpretation. These procedures helped maintain the reliability and accuracy of both quantitative and qualitative analyses conducted as part of the evaluation.

Triangulation Methods:

Four forms of triangulation were used to help ensure the validity of the evaluation findings:

Investigator Triangulation: All team members collaborated throughout the analysis process, and findings and recommendations were developed through group discussion and agreement. By involving all team members in the data collection and analysis processes and reaching a group consensus, a first form of triangulation was achieved.

Methodological Triangulation: The team used a mixed methods approach to cross reference quantitative and qualitative data. By comparing the quantitative survey data with the qualitative participant responses, we were able to achieve a second form of triangulation.

Environmental Triangulation: Data collection occurred in three separate waves to ensure full representation. Additionally, we interviewed around different neighborhoods and streets by the Beltline, to gain data for multiple LRRP participants. This provided a third type of triangulation.

Data Source Triangulation: This layered triangulation approach aimed to increase the likelihood of accurate interpretation of the data and strengthen the credibility of the findings. Each survey response acts as a separate data source, giving us a range of responses. (Hagen, 2024, Reading Packet D, p. 48).

Limitations

Several limitations were considered when interpreting the findings of our evaluation. First, not all LRRP participants may have completed the survey, which may introduce nonresponse bias. Additionally, because the survey relies on self-reported perceptions of quality of life, responses may be influenced by recall bias or social desirability bias, particularly during in-person canvassing where participants may feel inclined to provide more positive responses.

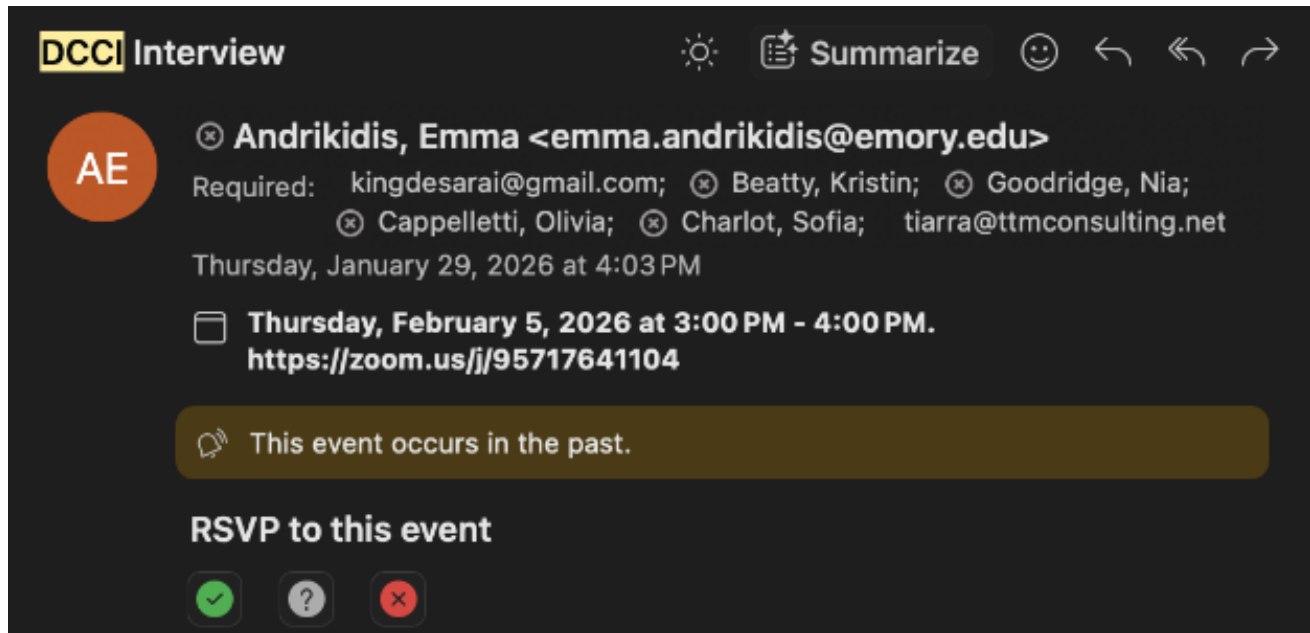
Findings from this evaluation were specific to participants in the LRRP and may not be generalizable to other populations or property tax relief programs in different geographic or policy contexts.

APPENDIX 2

Appendix 2.1: Data Collection Consultant Interview (DCCI) Materials

Recruitment Materials

Not available; Team Axolotl arranged and confirmed the DCCI via text message. The following screenshot is the calendar invite for the DCCI.



Data Collection Tool

1. Opening Questions
 - a. How would you describe your role and involvement with the (Legacy Resident Retention Program (LRRP)?
 - b. Will you be the person enacting the results or changes from this program evaluation? (aka key shareholder?)
2. Overall Evaluation Questions
 - a. Currently, our program evaluation question is as follows: To what extent has the LRRP impacted the quality of life of its participants?
 - b. Would you like to make any changes to the question?
 - c. What part of the definition for quality of life would you like us to focus on during this program evaluation?
3. Data Collection Process Questions
 - a. Where will we be collecting data?
 - b. Will canvassing be walkable, do we need to drive?
 - c. When is our data collection day, days, or week?
 - d. Is weekend or weekday better? One of each?
 - e. How will canvassing the survey work?
 - f. How long should it take to administer a survey?
 - g. What will our safety precautions be (e.g., pairs, during the day, etc.)?

- h. What happens if we do not get a full response rate?
 - i. How are people motivated to participate in the survey?
 - j. Are we allowed to have tea/coffee with them?
 - k. Do they get any incentives for participating?
 - l. Are there any taboos (i.e., surrounding gentrification) relating to this community that we should be aware of when interacting with them?
- 4. Survey Questions
 - a. How has the third version of the survey changed from the other previous two versions?
 - b. Is the survey finalized? If not, will we be assisting with editing the survey before we canvas?
- 5. Closing Questions
 - a. Before we end the interview, is there anything else you would like to mention that would help us with this program evaluation?

Appendix 2.2: Primary Data Collection Materials

Recruitment Materials

Not available; Ms. Murphy arranged the canvassing visits on behalf of Team Axolotl.

Data Collection Tool

Name:

Active Email:

Phone Number:

Address:

1. Why did you decide to join the LRRP? (Select all that apply)
 - a. Fear of losing my home
 - b. Rising property taxes
 - c. I want to pass my home on to the next generation
 - d. I was having financial challenges
 - e. I wanted extra support
 - f. Other
2. How did you first hear about the LRRP? (Select all that apply)
 - a. Word of mouth
 - b. Atlanta Beltline Website
 - c. Radio
 - d. Social media
 - e. Flyer
 - f. Yard Sign
 - g. Other
3. Which Empower Workshops have you attended?
 - a. Homestead Exemption Tax
 - b. Tax Appeal
 - c. Other classes not listed here.
 - d. I haven't attended any Empower workshops.
 - e. I'm not sure
4. Are you less worried about losing your home than before joining the LRRP?
 - a. Yes, much less worried
 - b. Yes, a little less worried
 - c. No change – I feel the same
 - d. No – I still feel at risk
 - e. I wasn't worried about losing my home before
5. Has having your property taxes paid helped you plan better for the future?
 - a. Yes, I feel more financially secure
 - b. Yes, I now have access to more resources
 - c. Somewhat, but I still have concern
 - d. No, I still feel unsure about the future
 - e. It hasn't made a difference
6. Before joining the LRRP and having your property taxes paid, how often did you experience worry or stress about money?
 - a. 1- Not at all

- b. 2- Rarely
 - c. 3- Sometimes
 - d. 4- Often
 - e. 5 -Everyday
7. Since joining the LRRP and having your property taxes paid, how often do you experience worry or stress about money?
- a. 1- Not at all
 - b. 2- Rarely
 - c. 3- Sometimes
 - d. 4- Often
 - e. 5 -Everyday
8. Before joining the LRRP, did you struggle to pay for any of these? (Select all that apply)
- a. Caring for loved ones
 - b. Transportation
 - c. Healthcare or prescriptions
 - d. Home repairs or maintenance
 - e. Utility bills
 - f. Groceries or food
 - g. Personal Care/Hygiene
 - h. Recreational/Fun activities
 - i. Child Care
 - j. Other
 - k. None of the above
9. Since joining the LRRP, did you struggle to pay for any of these? (Select all that apply)
- a. Caring for loved ones
 - b. Transportation
 - c. Healthcare or prescriptions
 - d. Home repairs or maintenance
 - e. Utility bills
 - f. Groceries or food
 - g. Personal Care/Hygiene
 - h. Recreational/Fun activities
 - i. Child Care
 - j. Other
 - k. None of the above
10. What are your feelings or concerns about this program ending in 2030?
- a. Open-ended
11. Do you currently have a will or estate plan? (A will or estate plan is a legal document that explains what should happen to your home, money, and other responsibilities—like who would care for your children—after you pass away. It helps make sure your wishes are followed and can make things easier for your loved ones.)
- a. Yes, I already have one
 - b. Yes, and I would like help updating my will or estate plan
 - c. No, but I would like to soon
 - d. No, but I would like help creating a will or estate plan
 - e. No, and I'm not interested right now
 - f. I'm not sure
 - g. Prefer not to say

12. Would you like help with any of the following? (Select all that apply)
 - a. Financial planning or money tips
 - b. Estate planning (wills, power of attorney)
 - c. Help with home repairs
 - d. Understanding property taxes
 - e. Stress or mental health support
 - f. Social Services
 - g. Other
 - h. I don't want or need more support
13. Do you have health insurance? (Click all that apply)
 - a. General Health Insurance
 - b. Dental Insurance
 - c. Vision Insurance
 - d. I have no health insurance
 - e. Other
14. How can we help your neighbors or community members get involved with the Empowerment Program?
 - a. Open-ended
15. What year was your home built? (If you're not sure, please give your best estimate)
 - a. Open-ended
16. Does our home need any repairs or improvements right now? (Select all that apply)
 - a. Plumbing (leaks, toilets, etc.)
 - b. Electrical (wiring, outlets, lighting)
 - c. Heating or air conditioning
 - d. Roof repairs
 - e. Windows or doors
 - f. Mold, pests, or water damage
 - g. Accessibility features (ramps, handrails)
 - h. General maintenance (painting, flooring, etc.)
 - i. No, my home doesn't need repairs
 - j. I'm not sure
 - k. Other
17. How do you usually access the internet? (Select all that apply)
 - a. Home computer/laptop/tablet
 - b. Cell phone
 - c. Library
 - d. A family member's device
 - e. I don't use the internet
 - f. other
18. Has the LRRP enhanced your overall well-being? Is there anything else you would like to share?
 - a. Open-ended– write N/A if nothing to add
19. Do you identify as living with a physical disability as defined by the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)? The ADA defines a disability as a physical and mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities. Physical disabilities may include mobility, chronic pain, visual or hearing impairments, or other long-term physical health conditions).
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
 - c. Prefer

- d. Not to say
 - e. Other
20. If yes, would you like to share the type of disability you identify with? (Optional)
- a. Mobility-related
 - b. Vision-related
 - c. Hearing-related
 - d. Chronic pain or chronic physical condition
 - e. Other physical disability
 - f. Prefer not to say
21. This information helps us understand accessibility needs and evaluate whether program outcomes differ across groups. You may skip this question.
22. Have you or someone in your household served in the U.S. military?
- a. Yes, I am a veteran
 - b. Yes, someone in my household is a veteran
 - c. No
 - d. Prefer not to say
23. What is your current work or job situation? (Select all that apply)
- a. I work full time
 - b. I work part time
 - c. I am retired
 - d. I'm Unemployed but looking for work
 - e. I'm unemployed and not looking for work
 - f. I work multiple jobs
 - g. I am a student
 - h. Prefer not to say
 - i. Other
24. How do you identify (race)? (select all that apply)
- a. Black or African American
 - b. Hispanic or Latino/a/x
 - c. White
 - d. Asian or Asian American
 - e. American Indian or Alaska Native
 - f. Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
 - g. Middle Eastern or North African
 - h. Multiracial / Mixed
 - i. Other (please specify): _____
 - j. Prefer not to answer
25. Are you Hispanic?
- a. Yes
 - b. No
26. If you are working or have recently worked, what is/was your job? (Example: teacher, home health aide, driver, etc.)
- a. Open ended
27. Would you like to receive text message updates about the LRRP?
- a. Yes
 - i. If yes, how many texts per month? (Open-ended)
 - b. No
28. Would you be open to sharing more about your experience or supporting the program in the

future? *(Select all that apply)*

- a. Yes, I'd be open to a one-on-one interview
- b. Yes, I'd be open to providing written feedback or a testimonial
- c. Yes, I'd be open to future surveys
- d. Yes, I'd be open to participating in program-related activities (if available)
- e. No, I'm not interested at this time

APPENDIX 3

Appendix 3.1: Shareholders

The following project shareholder table details the individuals who have an interest in LRRP program outcomes.

Program shareholders (Prog.) have an interest in the Legacy Residential Retention Program specifically.

Evaluation shareholders (Eval.) have an interest in the current evaluation of LRRP outcomes on participant quality of life.

Key shareholders (Key) are individuals who have the authority to act on the present evaluation's findings.

Primary Intended Users (PIU) are a subset of Key stakeholders who are most likely to act on the evaluation findings. Shareholders included in this evaluation project are listed in the table below.

PROJECT SHAREHOLDERS:	Prog.	Eval.	Key	PIU
Michael Davis (Deputy Executive Director)	X	X	X	X
Marian Davis (Empower Program Manager)	X	X	X	
Tiarra Murphy (Program Evaluation Consultant)	X	X		
Current LRRP participants	X	X		
Future LRRP participants	X	X		
Beltline Donors	X	X		

Appendix 3.2: Respondent Demographics

The most prevalent response for each category is highlighted

Item Domain	Category	n/165* (%)
Race & Ethnicity(multiselect)	Black or African American	120 (73%)
	White	21 (13%)
	American Indian or Alaska native	7 (04%)
	Multiracial or Mixed	3 (02%)
	Hispanic or Latino	1 (<01%)
	Asian or Asian American	1 (<01%)
	Middle Eastern or Northern African	1 (<01%)
	Prefer not to answer	11 (07%)

* Race & Ethnicity items reflect responses from the second and third wave of survey data collection. Reported frequencies reflect the subset of respondents who answered this question (n = 165), rather than the entire survey sample (n = 210).

The most prevalent response for each category is highlighted

Item Domain	Category	n/210 (%)
Employment Status(multiselect)	Working	87 (41%)
	Retired	88 (42%)
	Unemployed	14 (07%)
	Other	21 (10%)
Disability Status	Yes	57 (27%)
	No	140 (67%)
	Other	7 (03%)
	Prefer not to say	2 (03%)
Veteran Status	Yes	24 (11%)
	Yes, someone in my household is a veteran	13 (06%)
	No	171 (81%)
	Prefer not to say	2 (01%)

Appendix 3.3: Raw Data

The top two responses for each survey item are highlighted.

Survey item	Response Options	n/210 (%)
Are you less worried about losing your home than before joining the LRRP?	I wasn't worried about losing my home before	28 (13%)
	No change – I feel the same	21 (10%)
	No – I still feel at risk	13 (06%)
	Yes, a little less worried	56 (27%)
	Yes, much less worried	80 (38%)
Has having your property taxes paid helped you plan better for the future? (multiselect)	I feel more financially secure	105 (50%)
	Yes, I now have access to more resources	80 (38%)
	Somewhat, but I still have concern	68 (32%)
	No, I still feel unsure about the future	11 (05%)
	It hasn't made a difference	3 (01%)
Before joining the LRRP and having your property taxes paid, how often did you experience worry or stress about money?	1 - Not at all	4 (02%)
	2 - Rarely	13 (06%)
	3 - Sometimes	82 (39%)
	4 - Often	90 (43%)
	5 - Everyday	21 (10%)
Since joining the LRRP and having your property taxes paid, how often do you experience worry or stress about money?	1 - Not at all	19 (09%)
	2 - Rarely	46 (22%)
	3 - Sometimes	104 (50%)
	4 - Often	30 (14%)
	5 - Everyday	11 (5%)
Before joining the LRRP, did you struggle to pay for any of these?	Caring for loved ones	26 (12%)
	Transportation	47 (22%)
	Healthcare or prescriptions	60 (29%)

Survey item	Response Options	n/210 (%)
(multiselect)	Home repairs or maintenance	179 (85%)
	Utility bills	106 (50%)
	Groceries or food	77 (37%)
	Personal care hygiene	25 (12%)
	Recreational fun activities	48 (23%)
	Childcare	12 (06%)
	Other	12 (06%)
	None of the above	10 (05%)
Since joining the LRRP, did you struggle to pay for any of these? (multiselect)	Caring for loved ones	13 (6%)
	Transportation	31 (15%)
	Healthcare or prescriptions	40 (19%)
	Home repairs or maintenance	142 (68%)
	Utility bills	75 (36%)
	Groceries or food	46 (22%)
	Personal care hygiene	11 (05%)
	Recreational fun activities	42 (20%)
	Childcare	7 (03%)
	Other	10 (05%)
	None of the above	33 (16%)
Does your home need any repairs or improvements right now? (multiselect)	Plumbing leaks toilets etc.	83 (39%)
	Electrical wiring outlets lighting	107 (51%)
	Heating or air conditioning	69 (33%)
	Roof repairs	65 (31%)
	Windows or doors	124 (59%)
	Mold pests or water damage	65 (31%)
	Accessibility features ramps handrails	31 (15%)
	General maintenance, painting, flooring, etc.	128 (61%)

Survey item	Response Options	n/210 (%)
	No, my home doesn't need repairs	11 (05%)
	I'm not sure	3 (01%)
	Other	22 (11%)
Why did you decide to join the LRRP? (multiselect)	Fear of losing my home	68 (32%)
	Rising property taxes	199 (95%)
	I want to pass my home on to the next generation	102 (49%)
	I was having financial challenges	93 (44%)
	I wanted extra support	98 (47%)
How did you first hear about the LRRP?(multiselect)	Word of mouth	92 (44%)
	Atlanta Beltline Website	65 (31%)
	Radio	6 (03%)
	Social media	24 (11%)
	Flyer	52 (25%)
	Yard Sign	19 (09%)
	Other	39 (19%)
Do you currently have a will or estate plan?	Yes, I already have one	57 (27%)
	Yes, and I would like help updating my will or estate plan	35 (17%)
	No, but I would like to soon	43 (20%)
	No, but I would like help creating a will or estate plan	55 (26%)
	No, and I'm not interested right now	7 (03%)
	I'm in the process of creating one	1 (0.5%)
	I'm not sure	3 (01%)
	Prefer not to say	9 (04%)

APPENDIX 4

Appendix 4.1: Data Collection Crosswalk

Triangulation Categories Used:

Investigator: Multiple evaluators conducted the surveys via canvassing and conducted data analysis to mitigate potential oversights.

Methodology: Both quantitative (survey) and qualitative (focus groups quotes) methodologies were used to collect data, and the interpretation of findings were compared.

Data: Participants were asked both open and closed ended questions, and data collection was done in three separate iterations.

Information Sought:	Domain to be Assessed:	Indicators:	Data Source:	Data Collection Method:	Triangulation Method
<i>What are the organization members' key demographic characteristics?</i>	Demographics	• Racial & Ethnic identity • Education attainment • Employment status • Job title • Disability status • Veteran status	Survey responses	Survey data collection	Investigator
<i>How active are the organization's members in its activities?</i>	Participation	• Reason for joining LRRP • Awareness of LRRP • Number of Empower Workshops attended • How to get neighbors/community involved?	• Survey responses	Survey data collection	Investigator
<i>How can the organization best reach out to participants?</i>	Communication	• Internet access • Receiving texts from LRRP	• Survey responses	Survey data collection	Investigator

<i>How helpful did participants find the property tax payments?</i>	Quality of life	· Worry about losing home · Ability to plan for the future · Worry or stress about money · Struggling to pay for routine expenses · Ways LRRP has enhanced well-being	· Survey responses · Focus group quotes	Survey data collection	Methodology, Investigator, Data
<i>What resources do LRRP participants need/have access to?</i>	Resource support	· Future planning (estate/will) · Year home was built · Needing help with social services and/or material resources · Health Insurance coverage · Needing help with home repairs or improvements	· Survey	Survey data collection	Investigator
<i>How do LRRP participants feel about the program?</i>	Attitudes	· Program components that are doing well · Program components that need improvement · What would make the program more accessible · Feeling or concerns about the program ending in 2030	· Survey · Focus group quotes	Survey data collection	Methodology, Investigator, Data

Appendix 4.2: SORK Tables

SORK Table 1: Individuals Scores per Recommendation

Theme	Data-Driven Conclusions	Data-Driven Recommendations	Urgency: 4 = most 1 = least	Feasibility: 4 = most 1 = least	Data Source(s)
Extend the LRRP beyond 2030	Most of the LRRP participants are distressed about the program ending.	Extend the LRRP beyond 2030 to improve legacy resident quality of life.	4, 4, 4, 4, 4	2, 2, 2, 3, 2	Survey and focus group quotes
Enhance outreach strategies	Some of LRRP's outreach strategies are more effective than others.	Enhance outreach strategies to recruit more LRRP participants.	3, 4, 3, 2, 3	3, 3, 4, 4, 4	Survey and focus group quotes
Increase community engagement	There are no LRRP community-building initiatives to counteract the negative effects of gentrification.	Increase community engagement between the Atlanta Beltline Partnership and LRRP participants and neighborhoods.	4, 4, 4, 4, 3	2, 3, 4, 4, 3	Survey
Assist with home repairs	Many LRRP participants are struggling to pay for their home repairs.	Expand the scope of the LRRP to assist with home repairs and maintenance.	4, 3, 3, 2, 4	2, 2, 3, 1, 2	Survey and focus group quotes

SORK Table 2: Group Mean per Recommendation

Rec Code	Recommendation	Urgency	Feasibility
Extend the LRRP beyond 2030	Extend the LRRP beyond 2030 to improve legacy resident quality of life.	4	2.2
Enhance outreach strategies	Enhance outreach strategies to recruit more LRRP participants.	3	3.6
Increase community engagement	Increase community engagement between the Atlanta Beltline Partnership and LRRP participants and neighborhoods.	3.8	3.2
Assist with home repairs	Expand the scope of the LRRP to assist with home repairs and maintenance.	3.2	2.0

SORK Table 3: Recommendations Mapped to a 2x2 Feasibility and Urgency Table

		Urgency	
		More Urgent (average score = 3.0-4.0)	Less Urgent (average score = 1.0-2.9)
Feasibility	More Feasible (average score = 3.0-4.0)	<u>Urgent and Feasible</u> - Enhance outreach strategies - Increase community engagement	<u>Feasible but potentially Less Urgent</u> N/A
	Less Feasible (average score = 1.0-2.9)	<u>Urgent but potentially Less Feasible</u> - Extend the LRRP beyond 2030 - Assist with home repairs	<u>May be neither Feasible nor Urgent</u> N/A

Appendix 4.3: Inclusion Evaluation Practices Table

An Inclusive Practices table consists of all the strategies that the program evaluation team utilized to reduce Eurocentric bias and consider other cultural perspectives while conducting this program evaluation. Since our evaluation focuses on homeownership among historically marginalized communities, it was essential to center participants' lived experiences through the process. Below are the inclusive practices we employed when conducting this evaluation.

Euro-centric Perspective	Evaluation Application	Other Perspectives	Evaluation Application
Either/or thinking	• We made a single “best” choice	Both/and thinking	• We explored where there are tensions, duplications, and contradictions in the data • We focused on identifying opportunities for learning and growth
Perfectionism	• N/A	Good Enough	• We rounded numbers up and down in reports • We knew when to stop collecting data • We evaluated whether standards of success were relevant and tailored to the evaluation
“Progress” = ‘bigger’ and ‘more’	• N/A	“Progress” = movement towards equity and increased wellbeing	• We considered definitions of ‘success’ and ‘progress’ that went beyond growth in numbers • We thought about elements of progress that are less “tangible”, and how those can be included in the report • We prioritized how an evaluation can contribute to movement towards equity and increased well-being
Hierarchy (“What I say, goes”)	• N/A	Collectivism	• We had multiple individuals analyze the same data set • We focused on building relationships and holding everyone’s perspectives

Euro-centric Perspective	Evaluation Application	Other Perspectives	Evaluation Application
Worship of the written word	• We wrote things out as one of the most effective ways to communicate ideas	Communicate impact in multiple mediums	• We moved away from sole reliance on lengthy written reports to convey findings • We included more data visualization in reports • We expanded data collection beyond written surveys • We offered non-written options for input, like verbal survey administration
Sense of urgency	• We enforced deadlines when there was room for flexibility	Go slow to go fast	• We designed realistic work plans with built-in buffers and downtime • We invested time at the outset in relationship building with shareholders • We ensured time for relationships and trust building within the evaluation team before finalizing data collection methods and tools.